

Question:

A 5-year-old boy is brought to the physician by his mother because he does not “listen to her” anymore. The mother also reports that her son cannot concentrate on any tasks lasting longer than just a few minutes. Teachers at his preschool report that the patient is more active compared to other preschoolers, frequently interrupts or bothers other children, and is very forgetful. Last year the patient was expelled from another preschool for hitting his teacher and his classmates when he did not get what he wanted and for being disruptive during classes. He was born at term via vaginal delivery and has been healthy except for 3 episodes of acute otitis media at the age of 2 years. He has met all developmental milestones. His mother has major depressive disorder and his father has Graves' disease. He appears healthy and well nourished. Examination shows that the patient does not seem to listen when spoken to directly. The remainder of the examination shows no abnormalities. Which of the following is the most appropriate next step in treatment?

Answer Choices:

- A. Behavior therapy
- B. Methimazole
- C. Fluoxetine
- D. Hearing aids

Reasoning + Answer:

<answer> A. Behavior therapy </answer>

<think> Reasoning process :

- 1. The child is exhibiting behavioral problems such as lack of listening skills , short attention span , and frequent disruptions , which are common symptoms of Attention Deficit Hyper activity Disorder (ADHD).
- 2. The child 's history of hitting his teachers and classmates also suggests that he may be struggling with impulse control , which is a characteristic of ADHD .
- 3. The child 's neglect of personal hygiene and appearance , along with his difficulties with social interactions , also raise concerns about his overall development and functioning .
- 4. The presence of developmental delays in areas of social and emotional development suggests that a medical condition such as ADHD or autism may be contributing to his behavior .
- 5. The family 's history of ADHD in the mother is also a risk factor for the child 's development of ADHD .

Based on the above information , behavior therapy would be the most appropriate next step in treatment , as it can help the child develop coping mechanisms and strategies to manage his ADHD symptoms and behavioral problems . Medications such as methimazole (used to treat hyperthyroidism) and fluoxetine (an antidepressant) may also be used to treat comorbid conditions , but they would not directly address the child 's ADHD symptoms . Hearing aids are not relevant to the child 's symptoms .